Portfolio Review Report

Designer: Bryan D. Robinson
Portfolio URL: https://www.bryandrobinson.com/
Review Date: April 3, 2026
Target Level (inferred): Entry-level / Junior Graphic Designer
Role Type (stated): Graphic Designer (full-time)
Goal: Land a full-time graphic design role
Reviewed by: Portfolio Review Agent (hiring manager perspective)

Overall Readiness: 5 / 10 for entry-level graphic design roles

Executive Summary

> Bryan's portfolio shows genuine visual craft, and the award wins — Gold Graphis New Talent (2024), Gold AAF Atlanta, and Regional Addy — are real, meaningful differentiators that prove the work isn't just student-project wallpaper. The theatre-as-storytelling narrative threading through his About page is distinct and memorable. However, the portfolio is held back by a collection of issues that undercut what the work itself could do: shallow case study documentation (challenge + solution + gallery is not a case study), a resume that exists only as a JPEG (not readable, not downloadable as text, not ATS-friendly), and a homepage headline of "What's up everybody." that signals casual social media rather than professional hire-me energy. Every single project is concept or student work — none of it shipped to a real client — which is understandable for an early-career designer but must be compensated for with stronger process storytelling. A hiring manager would see promise here and want to know more, but the current portfolio doesn't convert that curiosity into a callback.

Issue Log

#	Dimension	Severity	Issue	Recommendation
1	IA / Resume	Critical	The resume page displays a JPEG image (BryanRobinsonResumeV2.jpg). It cannot be downloaded as a PDF, cannot be copied, is not searchable, and is not ATS-compatible.	Replace with a downloadable PDF. Rename the file to "BryanRobinsonResume.pdf" — drop the "V2" version flag entirely.
2	Case Studies	Critical	All 8 projects are concept or student work with no shipped client outcomes. While appropriate for early-career, this must be compensated by strong process documentation — which is largely absent.	Add at minimum 1–2 real-client or freelance projects. For concept work, go deeper on the thinking: what constraints did you design within? What alternatives did you reject and why?
3	Case Studies	Critical	7 of 8 case studies show no target audience or user context. Who is the design actually for? Without this, a hiring manager cannot evaluate whether the design decisions were appropriate.	Add a brief audience description to every case study. "Warriors Branding" example: "Designed for Broadway-aware theatregoers aged 25–45, familiar with hip-hop and NYC culture."
4	Copy	Critical	Homepage headline is "What's up everybody." — a casual greeting that reads as a social media bio, not a professional hire-me statement. A recruiter arriving on this page in 5 seconds does not know what Bryan does or what he's looking for.	Replace with a specific positioning statement. Example: "Graphic designer specializing in brand identity, experiential design, and packaging — with a background in theatre that puts storytelling at the center of every project."
6	IA	Major	The Resume page lives at the URL slug "/new-page" — a default Squarespace placeholder that was never changed. This is visible in the browser address bar and in any link shared to recruiters.	Change the URL slug to "/resume" in Squarespace page settings. Takes 30 seconds.

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7	Case Studies	Major	Most case studies follow the same thin structure: challenge sentence + solution sentence + image gallery. There is almost no process documentation — no sketches with reasoning, no iteration narrative, no decision rationale beyond the opening sentences.	For each case study, add at least one section that explains a design decision: "I chose X over Y because Z." Show early explorations or rejected directions. This is where the thinking lives.
8	Case Studies	Major	No case study states Bryan's specific role or contribution. Did he do everything himself? Was this a class project? Solo or team? Hiring managers need to know what he personally owns.	Add a brief role statement to every case study. Example: "Solo student project — concept to final deliverables. Tools: Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects."
9	Case Studies	Major	No prototype, demo, or interactive link exists for any project. Static mockups alone are insufficient for evaluating design quality at depth.	For at least the 2–3 strongest projects, embed a Figma prototype or add a short screen-recording walkthrough (Loom works well). Even a 60-second narrated video is a significant differentiator.
10	Copy	Major	Award capitalization on the Euclid Brewer page reads: "gOLD gRAPHIS nEW tALENT award" — appears to be an unintentional mixed-case formatting error. This is a high-visibility claim undermined by sloppy presentation.	Fix to read: "Winner of the 2024 Gold Graphis New Talent Award." Add the same award callout to the homepage project thumbnail or About page where it's seen early.
11	About	Major	The About page has no concrete impact statement — no example of value delivered, no metric, no before/after. The copy describes what Bryan wants to do but doesn't evidence what he has done.	Add one specific proof point. Example: "The Melt Cookbook won a Gold AAF Atlanta and Regional Addy Award, one of two entries from my school to advance to regionals that

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				year." Specificity builds credibility.
12	Positioning	Major	The IDEA project (MODA summer camp redesign) involves fieldwork, student interviews, and program strategy — it reads as service design or UX research, not graphic design. It feels out of place among 7 branding/experiential projects and may confuse a recruiter about what Bryan actually does.	Either (a) reframe IDEA to emphasize the visual/brand deliverables that came out of the research, or (b) replace it with a graphic design project that's more on-brand. Don't let one outlier dilute a coherent specialty.
13	CTAs	Major	There is no resume download link or PDF on the About/Contact page itself — the resume requires navigating to a separate page and viewing an image. Contact and resume should both be accessible from the same place.	Add a "Download Resume (PDF)" link on the About/Contact page alongside the email address.
14	Copy	Minor	The About copy includes generic phrases like "deliver designs that are not only effective but also create a memorable impact" and "innovative, strategic designs that drive interest." These could describe any designer anywhere.	Replace generic claims with specific ones. What specifically does your theatre background give you that other designers don't have? Name it. "Understanding dramatic structure means I think about how a brand unfolds as a story over time — not just how it looks on a single surface."

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15	IA	Minor	No location is stated on the homepage. It appears only on the About page. Recruiters hiring for in-person or specific-market roles need to know upfront if Bryan is local, remote-available, or willing to relocate.	Add location (and relocation/remote openness) to the homepage headline area or the homepage meta description. "Based in Simpsonville, SC — open to relocation" or similar.

Section-by-Section Analysis

Copy & Writing NEEDS WORK

The single biggest copy problem is the homepage headline. "*What's up everybody.*" is a casual greeting that signals Instagram bio energy, not professional designer energy. A hiring manager who lands on this page is scanning for: who is this person, what do they do, why should I care? That greeting answers none of those questions. By the time they click through to About, many have already formed an impression — and it's not "I need to interview this person."

The About page copy is more substantive and the storytelling angle — "*My background in theatre has given me a desire to always create my designs with the story in mind*" — is genuinely distinctive. This is the strongest copywriting on the site and it earns its place. Protect it. But it's surrounded by generic filler: "*innovative, strategic designs that drive interest and tell a powerful story*" could have been written by a corporate HR bot. Strip the clichés and let the theatre angle breathe.

The award capitalization on Euclid Brewer — "*gOLD gRAPHIS nEW tALENT award*" — appears to be an accidental mixed-case formatting error. This is ironic because it's the strongest credentialing moment in the portfolio and it's presented in a way that makes a reader do a double-take for the wrong reasons. Fix this immediately.

Case study copy is thin but clean. The challenge/solution format works as a framework; the problem is the sentences don't go deep enough. "Develop a new branded identity for an already historically successful sports team" (Boston Celtics) is a brief, not an insight. What was the creative tension? What made this hard?

Issues found

- 🔴 Homepage headline "What's up everybody." — too casual, communicates nothing professional
- 🟡 Award formatting error: "gOLD gRAPHIS nEW tALENT award" — mixed caps looks like a bug
- 🟡 Generic filler phrases in About copy undercut the distinctive theatre angle
- 🟢 Case study challenge/solution copy is serviceable but lacks depth or creative tension

Recommendations

- Replace "What's up everybody." with a specific positioning statement that names what you do and signals your angle (storytelling, theatre, experiential design)
- Fix the Euclid Brewer award capitalization — make it a proud, properly formatted callout
- Audit the About copy: delete every sentence that could apply to "any designer" and replace it with something only Bryan could say

Information Architecture NEEDS WORK

The homepage does one thing right: the work is immediately visible. There's no splash screen, no intro animation to wait through, no buried gallery — you land and you see projects. That's the right instinct.

The navigation has two problems. First, the Resume page lives at the URL slug `/new-page` — a Squarespace default that was never customized. This appears in the browser address bar whenever someone follows the Resume link from the nav. Second, the resume itself is an image file, not a PDF. A recruiter cannot copy text from it, download it as a document, or paste it into their ATS.

Navigation labels are otherwise appropriate. The structure — Work, About, Resume, LinkedIn — is clean and logical. The About/Contact combination on one page is a reasonable choice for a portfolio this size.

Issues found

- 🟡 Resume page URL slug is "/new-page" — should be "/resume"
- 🔴 Resume is a JPEG image, not a downloadable PDF
- 🟢 No location or remote/relocation status on homepage

Recommendations

- Change the Resume page URL slug to "/resume"
- Replace resume image with a downloadable PDF named "BryanRobinsonResume.pdf"

- Consider adding a brief location/availability line near the homepage headline

Positioning, Personal Brand & Originality ADEQUATE

Bryan's specialization — Experiential Design, Branding, Merchandising — is reasonably specific and coherent. The 7 projects that fit this lane (Warriors, Celtics, Diamonds, Euclid, Melt, Sondheim, Queen's Ball) hang together as a body of work. There's a clear aesthetic sensibility around bold branded systems, environmental applications, and merchandise design.

The theatre background as a positioning angle is the most differentiating thing in the portfolio. A graphic designer who frames their practice around narrative and storytelling — and who can explain why a diamond-shaped morphing stage communicates the same way a three-act structure does — is interesting. That's not a skill most graphic designers can claim, and it's rooted in genuine biography rather than copywriting. The About page gestures at this but doesn't fully commit to it. It should be the organizing idea of the entire portfolio.

The IDEA case study disrupts the positioning coherence. It reads as UX research and service design strategy — a different discipline — and sits oddly among 7 visually-oriented branding projects. A recruiter hiring for graphic design roles will be confused by it.

The portfolio does feel like Squarespace — the template is recognizable. For a designer whose work is about bold visual identity, having the portfolio itself run on a default grid layout without visible customization creates a modest disconnect. This isn't a dealbreaker, but a few deliberate visual choices at the portfolio level would reinforce the brand.

Issues found

- 🟡 IDEA project disrupts positioning coherence — reads as UX/strategy, not graphic design
- 🟡 The theatre/storytelling angle is present in About but not expressed in the portfolio's visual identity or structure
- 🟢 Portfolio runs on a recognizable Squarespace template without visible customization

Recommendations

- Either reframe IDEA around its visual/brand deliverables or replace it with a more on-brand project
- Carry the storytelling angle into the portfolio structure itself — even the nav, section headers, or case study intros can have a narrative voice

- Consider one deliberate visual customization to the Squarespace template that signals ownership of the aesthetic (typography choice, color palette, hover interaction)

Skills Demonstrated ADEQUATE

The breadth of deliverable types across 8 projects is genuinely impressive for an early-career portfolio: brand identity systems, typography, environmental/signage design, packaging, merchandise, publication design, product design, and exhibit design. This range is a real asset for a designer pursuing graphic design roles where versatility is valued.

What's not demonstrated: the thinking behind the work. Process, iteration, and decision-making are almost entirely absent. A hiring manager can see that Bryan produces polished final deliverables, but they have no evidence of how he arrives at them. At entry-level, being able to show that you can think through a design problem — not just execute a beautiful solution — is what separates candidates who get interviews from those who don't.

Skills evidenced

- Brand identity systems (logo, typography, color, applications)
- Experiential and environmental design (stage, exhibit, tunnel installations)
- Packaging design (Euclid Brewer, Melt Cookbook)
- Publication/editorial design (Melt Cookbook)
- Merchandise design (across multiple projects)
- Mockup and presentation craft

Skills claimed but not shown

- "Strategic designs" — no strategy process is documented in any case study
- "Turning concepts into tangible experiences" — shown as outcome, not as process

Skills absent for target level

- Process documentation / iteration history
- Client communication or brief interpretation
- Typography rationale (font choices are shown, never explained)

Case Study Analysis CRITICAL GAP

Warriors Branding

Foundations: Client ✅ (Lin-Manuel Miranda concept album) · Context ✅ (staged version of the album) · Users ❌ (no audience described) · Problem space ✅ (create brand identity)

Process / solution balance: Challenge sentence + solution sentence + gallery. No process visible. The design work carries the case study entirely.

Design clarity & rationale: The aesthetic direction (1970s NYC, graffiti, black/white/red) is stated and makes sense given the source material. The "W tag" as the central device is explained. This is the most reasoned case study in the portfolio — the rationale is thin but present.

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent** (concept work, none expected but a Figma mockup walkthrough would help)

Strengths: Clear aesthetic identity, strong conceptual through-line, deliverable range is impressive (posters, playbill, merch, environmental)

Issues: 🟡 No target audience defined; 🟡 no iteration or rejected directions shown

Missing: Who is this designed to attract to the theatre? What did the brief actually ask for? What alternatives were explored before landing on the W tag device?

Boston Celtics Logo Redesign

Foundations: Client ✅ (Boston Celtics, concept) · Context ✅ (rebrand of established team) · Users ❌ (no fan audience described) · Problem space ✅

Process / solution balance: Challenge sentence + solution sentence + extensive gallery. The gallery is the heaviest in the portfolio (jerseys, court, merchandise, arena). No process shown.

Design clarity & rationale: The design direction is described — "marries classic elements with modern aesthetics" — but this is a generic claim. What specifically makes this Celtics and not any other team? What was the decision behind the geometric/line-based system? These questions are unanswered.

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent**

Strengths: Comprehensive system design, strong mockup execution across multiple touchpoints

Issues: 🟡 Rationale is generic; 🟡 no audience or fan insight; 🟡 custom typeface is shown but not discussed

Missing: Why geometric/industrial? What does Boston's spirit specifically mean in visual terms? How does this system differentiate the Celtics from other NBA rebrands?

Diamonds Are Forever Stage

Foundations: Client ✅ (Jay-Z, concept) · Context ✅ (world tour concept) · Users ❌ (no concert audience described) · Problem space ✅

Process / solution balance: This is the strongest case study for process — shape sketches and iterations are mentioned, and the diamond metaphor is explained through the concept. Still thin, but the conceptual logic is visible.

Design clarity & rationale: The morphing stage concept (diamond breaks apart and reassembles) is genuinely interesting and directly tied to the music's thematic content. This is the most conceptually coherent project in the portfolio.

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent** — a stage concept especially benefits from an animation or video showing the transformation

Strengths: Strongest conceptual rationale in the portfolio; the stage-as-storytelling device aligns directly with Bryan's positioning

Issues: 🟡 No audience framing; 🟡 sketch/iteration is mentioned but not shown in depth

Missing: Show the actual shape exploration sketches. This is the one case study where process artifacts would directly strengthen the narrative.

Euclid Brewer 🏆 Gold Graphis New Talent 2024

Foundations: Client ❌ (concept product, no client) · Context ✅ (coffee maker redesign) · Users ❌ (no coffee drinker described) · Problem space ✅ (remove margin of error in brewing)

Process / solution balance: Challenge/solution/gallery. The golden ratio imagery is shown as a design element but not explained. Given this won a Gold award, a hiring manager wants to understand the thinking behind it.

Design clarity & rationale: The built-in scale solution is clever and clearly stated. The app mockup and packaging are shown. However, the naming (Euclid — the mathematician of geometry) is unexplained. The golden ratio connection is implied but not made explicit.

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent** — the app mockup especially warrants an interactive prototype

Strengths: Award win is the strongest credential in the portfolio; product design + packaging + app system shows range; the precision-brewing concept is well-grounded

Issues: 🟡 Award is buried and oddly formatted — this should be featured prominently; 🟡 Naming rationale (Euclid, golden ratio) is implied but unexplained

Missing: Why "Euclid"? Walk through the naming and the geometric visual system. This is your best work — give it the depth it deserves.

Melt Cookbook 🏆 Gold AAF Atlanta + Regional Addy

Foundations: Client ❌ (concept cookbook) · Context ✅ · Users ❌ (no reader described) · Problem space ✅

Process / solution balance: Challenge/solution/gallery. The cookbook concept is clear — sandwiches across all meals, comfort food as through-line. The visual language is described as "expressive and vibrant."

Design clarity & rationale: What does the cookbook actually look like? The fetched content describes it but doesn't convey the visual design choices. Given the award win, the visual execution is presumably strong — but the rationale for the design approach is absent.

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent**

Strengths: Second award win; comfort food as a design brief gives personality latitude; accessible, everyday subject matter

Issues: 🟡 Award is mentioned but not featured prominently; 🟡 no explanation of the visual design language choices (typography, color, grid system)

Missing: Why "expressive and vibrant" for a sandwich cookbook? What was the visual inspiration? Show 2–3 interior spreads with annotations explaining the design decisions.

Sondheim Exhibit

Foundations: Client ❌ (concept museum exhibit) · Context ✅ (memorial exhibit following Sondheim's passing) · Users ❌ (no museum visitor described) · Problem space ✅

Process / solution balance: Challenge/solution/gallery. The narrative of the exhibit (success → failure → resurgence) is compelling and reflects Bryan's theatre background directly.

Design clarity & rationale: The exhibit structure — guiding visitors through periods of Sondheim's career — is conceptually sound and emotionally resonant. The "resilience and transformative power of bouncing back" framing is the strongest writing in any case study.

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent**

Strengths: Most emotionally resonant project; the narrative arc directly demonstrates Bryan's storytelling positioning; exhibit design shows environmental design skills

Issues: 🟡 No visitor experience journey described; 🟡 no discussion of how the space physically guides movement

Missing: A floor plan or visitor journey map would make this exhibit feel real rather than theoretical. Who visits this exhibit — casual museum-goers or theatre fans? How does the design serve different audience types?

IDEA (MODA)

Foundations: Client ✅ (Museum of Design Atlanta) · Context ✅ (summer camp redesign) · Users ✅ (middle school students — most specific audience in the portfolio) · Problem space ✅

Process / solution balance: The most process-documented project — fieldwork and interviews are mentioned. However, what was actually designed? The fetched content describes research and strategy but does not mention visual deliverables.

Design clarity & rationale: The design solution ("a new approach to education that can adapt and change over time") sounds like a strategy recommendation, not a graphic design artifact. What did Bryan actually make? A visual identity for the program? Curriculum materials? A brand system?

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent**

Strengths: Only project with real client (MODA), real users (middle schoolers), and research process; the fieldwork shows initiative

Issues: 🟡 Reads as UX/service design strategy, not graphic design — out of place in this portfolio; 🟡 the design output is unclear

Missing: Show the actual design deliverables. If there are visual artifacts (program branding, signage, print materials), lead with those. If not, this project is doing more harm than good and should be replaced.

The Queen's Ball

Foundations: Client ❌ (concept for Beyoncé) · Context ✅ (Renaissance World Tour fan activation) · Users ✅ (Beyoncé fans) · Problem space ✅

Process / solution balance: Challenge/solution/gallery. The two-component concept (interactive tunnel + merchandise system) is explained concisely.

Design clarity & rationale: The per-song geometric shape system for merchandise is genuinely clever — it creates a direct link between music content and physical product design. The Sphere context is appropriate and shows awareness of current cultural venues.

Live link / prototype / demo: ❌ **Absent** — the tunnel interaction especially warrants a video or animation concept

Strengths: Strongest audience-centric concept in the portfolio; per-song merchandise system is a memorable idea; Sphere venue choice is culturally current

Issues: 🟡 No process shown; 🟡 the tunnel interaction is described but not visualized in depth

Missing: A diagram or storyboard of the tunnel experience would make this feel designed rather than described.

Overall Case Study Assessment

The portfolio's most consistent weakness is the gap between the visual quality of the output (evidenced by two award wins) and the shallowness of the case study documentation. Every case study follows the same two-sentence challenge/solution formula before dropping into a gallery. This means a hiring manager can admire the executions but cannot evaluate Bryan's design thinking — which is what separates a junior designer who can execute from one who can contribute ideas.

The strongest case studies are Diamonds Are Forever (clearest conceptual logic), Warriors Branding (clearest visual rationale), and The Queen's Ball (most audience-aware concept). The weakest are IDEA (unclear output, wrong discipline) and Boston Celtics (generic rationale for a comprehensive system). Euclid Brewer and Melt Cookbook are the most credential-backed and deserve the deepest documentation investment — if you won awards for it, write the story that explains why.

Recommendation: Choose the 5–6 strongest pieces (suggest: Warriors, Diamonds, Euclid, Melt, Sondheim, Queen's Ball) and double the documentation depth of each. Cut IDEA or reframe it entirely. Quality of documentation over quantity of projects.

Call-to-Actions ADEQUATE

The CTA on the About page — "Let's talk about your next project" with a visible email address — is functional and appropriately direct. The email is displayed in full uppercase (BRYANDANIELROBINSON@GMAIL.COM) which is readable but unconventional; standard title case or lowercase is easier to scan.

LinkedIn is linked from navigation, which is the right place for it. There is no phone number, which is a minor omission — some recruiters still call. There is no calendar booking link (not required at entry level but a nice touch).

The resume is linked from navigation but leads to a JPEG, not a downloadable file. This breaks the CTA chain for any recruiter who clicks "Resume" expecting something they can send to a hiring manager or import into their system.

Issues found

- 🔴 Resume link leads to a JPEG, not a downloadable PDF
- 🟡 No resume download link on the About/Contact page itself
- 🟢 Email in full uppercase — readable but unconventional

Recommendations

- Replace resume with a downloadable PDF and link it from both the nav and the About/Contact page
- Add a "Download Resume" button directly below the email on the contact page
- Consider normalizing email capitalization to standard case

About Me & Essential Information ADEQUATE

✅ **Who they are** — Name, location (Simpsonville, SC), role (graphic designer) all present

✅ **What they do** — Experiential Design, Branding, Merchandising — specific enough

✅ **What they're good at** — Storytelling-driven design, bringing products to life through visuals — stated if not proven

❌ **Impact they've had** — No concrete example. Awards are mentioned in case studies but not surfaced here where they'd have the most effect

The About page has a strong foundation. The opening — "*What's up everybody. I'm Bryan, a graphic designer originally from Simpsonville, SC*" — is casual but it does establish identity quickly. The theatre background paragraph is the most differentiated copy on the site and it earns its place.

What's missing is the proof. The About page tells us Bryan *aims* to deliver impact and *specializes* in turning concepts into experiences — but it never shows us that he has. Two award wins (Graphis New Talent Gold, AAF Gold + Regional Addy) should be on this page. They're not. This is a missed opportunity every time a recruiter visits About before looking at work.

Issues found

- 🟡 No impact statement or award callouts on the About page
- 🟡 Generic claims not supported by evidence on the page
- 🟢 Casual greeting tone may not suit all hiring contexts

Recommendations

- Add a brief credential line to the About page: "Recent award wins include the 2024 Gold Graphis New Talent Award (Euclid Brewer) and a Gold AAF Atlanta + Regional Addy Award (Melt Cookbook)."
- Replace at least two generic claim sentences with specific examples that only Bryan could write

Visual Design Quality ADEQUATE

Portfolio site

The portfolio's own design reads as a clean, competent Squarespace grid — work thumbnails displayed at a consistent size, navigation is readable, whitespace is used generously. The site does not violate any of Dieter Rams' principles (it's useful, unobtrusive, understandable), but it also doesn't demonstrate them with any authorial voice. The portfolio doesn't signal that a designer made intentional choices here — it signals that someone used a template thoughtfully but didn't claim it as their own.

The gestalt principles are largely satisfied: proximity groups project thumbnails, similarity makes the grid scannable, hierarchy is functional. There's no evidence of continuity problems or figure/ground failures.

Work samples

Based on the award recognition (Graphis New Talent Gold, AAF Gold, Regional Addy), the visual execution of at least Euclid Brewer and Melt Cookbook is demonstrably strong — these are juried awards evaluated by design professionals. The range of deliverable types (posters, jerseys, packaging, exhibit installations, merchandise) suggests solid craft across multiple surfaces.

What cannot be assessed without direct visual access: typography specificity, color system coherence across a full project, and image legibility within case studies. Hiring managers will be evaluating at this level of detail — ensure final design screens are shown at maximum width, not as small thumbnails in a grid.

Issues found

- 🟡 Portfolio site design doesn't reflect Bryan's own aesthetic voice — it reads as a template, not a personal visual statement
- 🟡 Cannot confirm image legibility within case studies — screens may be too small to evaluate design decisions at detail level

Recommendations

- Make at least one deliberate visual choice on the portfolio site itself — typography, a custom color accent, a hover treatment — that signals authorship
- Ensure all final design screens in case studies are shown at near-full width. A hiring manager who can't read the UI labels or see the type details cannot evaluate your craft

Portfolio Usability NEEDS WORK

Scannability

The homepage is scannable — project titles are visible, thumbnails are consistent, and navigation is clear. The About page is moderately scannable; the key information (what Bryan does, how to contact him) can be extracted without reading every word. Case study pages are not scannable — they rely on reading the full challenge/solution text and looking at every image to understand the project. Section headers within case studies appear to be absent or minimal.

Navigation

Navigation is consistent across pages (Work, About, Resume, LinkedIn in the header). The /new-page URL is a persistent credibility signal to anyone who notices it. Inside case studies, there's no breadcrumb or "back to work" navigation besides the browser back button — a minor friction point for hiring managers moving through multiple projects quickly.

Cognitive load

The homepage is focused and doesn't overwhelm. 8 projects is slightly on the higher end but manageable for an entry-level portfolio. Case study pages are gallery-heavy — extensive image scrolling without interpretive text between images can become fatiguing. The work is doing all the communicating, and without copy to guide attention, the experience is passive.

Performance

Cannot fully audit without browser testing, but Squarespace portfolios with high-resolution mockup images can load slowly, especially on mobile. The mockup-heavy projects (Celtics, Diamonds, Queen's Ball) likely have large image files. This is worth checking via Google PageSpeed Insights.

Issues found

- 🟡 No "back to work" link inside case studies — nav-dependent return
- 🟡 Case study pages lack section headers to aid scanning
- 🟢 Performance untested — recommend running PageSpeed audit on the most image-heavy case studies

Recommendations

- Add section headers within case studies (e.g., "The Brief", "Design Direction", "Applications", "What I Learned")
- Add a "← Back to Work" link at the top and bottom of each case study page
- Run a PageSpeed audit and compress/optimize any images over 500KB

Positioning Coherence ADEQUATE

Seven of the eight projects cohere around a clear graphic design identity: bold branded systems for entertainment, sports, food, and experiential contexts. The through-line is strong. Bryan's stated specialties — Experiential Design, Branding, Merchandising — are well-evidenced by the work.

The single coherence problem is IDEA. A service design / UX strategy project for a museum education program sits in a different discipline bucket from the other seven projects. A recruiter scanning the project grid sees: theatre branding, sports rebrand, concert stage, coffee maker, cookbook, exhibit, education strategy, Beyoncé activation. One of these is not like the others, and in a portfolio context, the outlier creates doubt rather than demonstrating range.

The copy and the work also have a minor gap: the About page claims "packaging that stands out on the shelves" as an area, and the Euclid Brewer confirms this — but no other project is packaging-focused. Melt Cookbook is publication design. If packaging is a genuine specialty, Bryan may want to add another packaging project to back it up, or soften the claim.

Issues found

- 🟡 IDEA project creates discipline confusion within an otherwise coherent graphic design portfolio
- 🟢 "Packaging" is claimed in About but only evidenced by one project

Recommendations

- Replace or reframe IDEA so it leads with visual/brand deliverables if they exist, or remove it and replace with a graphic design project
- If packaging is a real focus, add a second packaging project or moderate the claim in About copy

Leadership Signal Evaluation

N/A — target level is entry-level / junior. Leadership signal evaluation applies to Lead, Staff, Principal, Director, and VP-level portfolios.

Level Assessment

Does this portfolio read as an entry-level / junior graphic designer? Partially.

The visual craft — evidenced by the award wins — clearly meets and exceeds entry-level expectations. Two juried awards (Graphis New Talent, AAF Gold + Regional Addy) are genuine proof points that the work is competitive. The breadth of deliverable types and the coherence of the branded systems demonstrate that Bryan can handle real projects.

What doesn't read at entry-level is the portfolio infrastructure: the resume-as-image, the /new-page slug, and the shallow case study documentation are the kinds of things a recent graduate might leave unfixed because they don't know they matter. They do. A hiring manager looking at two candidates with similar visual craft will advance the one whose portfolio signals professional self-awareness — that they understand their portfolio is a design project too, and they gave it the same attention they gave their case studies.

- **Intern:** Overqualified — the award wins place this above intern-level work
- **Entry-level / Junior:** Competitive, but the portfolio infrastructure issues will cost callbacks that the work itself deserves to earn
- **Mid-level:** Not yet — no real client work, no demonstrated process thinking, no shipped outcomes

Priority Action Plan

1. 🔴 **Fix the resume — today.** Replace BryanRobinsonResumeV2.jpg with a downloadable PDF named BryanRobinsonResume.pdf. Change the page URL slug from "/new-page" to "/resume". Add a download link on the About/Contact page. This is a 30-minute fix that removes a dealbreaker from every recruiter's experience.

2. 🔴 **Replace the homepage headline.** "What's up everybody." needs to go. Write a specific positioning statement that names what you do and signals your angle. Draft 3 options, test them with a friend who doesn't know you, and pick the one

that makes them say "I'd want to hire that person." This is the first thing every hiring manager reads.

3. 🔴 **Add process and rationale to your three best case studies.** Pick Euclid Brewer, Warriors Branding, and Diamonds Are Forever. For each: add a section that walks through at least one key design decision — what you considered, what you rejected, and why you landed where you did. Show the sketches. Fix the "gOLD gRAPHIS" capitalization on Euclid. These three are your strongest pieces; they deserve the depth that will make a hiring manager call you.

4. 🟡 **Remove or fix IDEA and fix the /new-page slug.** Two quick infrastructure fixes: change the Resume page URL slug to "/resume", and either reframe IDEA around its visual deliverables or swap it for a stronger graphic design project. Each takes under 10 minutes and removes signals that undercut the professional impression of the work.

5. 🟡 **Surface your awards on the About page and homepage.** Two award wins are the strongest credentials in this portfolio and they're buried in individual case study pages. Add them to the About page intro. Consider adding small award badges to the Euclid and Melt project thumbnails on the homepage. Let a recruiter know before they even click into a project that this work has been recognized by industry professionals.

What's Working — Don't Break These

- **The theatre/storytelling angle.** "My background in theatre has given me a desire to always create my designs with the story in mind" — this is specific, differentiating, and genuinely Bryan's. It's not a claim every graphic designer can make. Protect it, develop it, and make it the organizing idea of the entire portfolio rather than a paragraph on the About page.
- **The award wins.** Gold Graphis New Talent and Gold AAF Atlanta + Regional Addy are real, juried credentials from respected programs. At entry level, these separate Bryan from the field. They just need to be displayed more prominently and explained with the depth they deserve.

- **The breadth of deliverable types.** Across 8 projects Bryan demonstrates posters, logos, packaging, publication design, apparel, environmental signage, exhibit installations, product design, and app mockups. This range is a real asset for a graphic designer and it's evident from scanning the portfolio.
- **The conceptual intelligence of Diamonds Are Forever and The Queen's Ball.** These two projects show a designer thinking about the experiential dimension of a brand — how it unfolds in space and time, how it connects to the emotional content of the music. This is a level of thinking above "make it look good." Don't let it get lost in thin case study copy.
- **Contact accessibility.** The email is directly visible on the About page without hunting. In a world of buried contact forms, this is the right call. Keep it.

Hiring Manager Verdict

Here's what I'd tell a recruiter: Bryan's visual craft is real and the award wins prove it. I'd be curious enough to look at the work. But I wouldn't advance him to a first-round interview based on the portfolio as it stands today — and the reason isn't the quality of the design work. It's that the portfolio tells me he hasn't yet treated his own portfolio as a design project with the same standards he applies to client work.

The resume-as-image, the /new-page URL, the thin case studies — these aren't small errors, they're signals. They tell me that either Bryan doesn't know these things matter (a knowledge gap we can fix) or that he does know and hasn't fixed them (a judgment gap that's harder to explain away). For an entry-level role at a design-literate company, those signals matter.

What would make me say yes: give Euclid Brewer and Warriors Branding the case study depth they deserve, fix the three infrastructure issues that take less than an hour combined, put a real headline on the homepage, and surface those award wins where a recruiter sees them in the first 10 seconds. Do those five things and this portfolio is competitive. The craft is there. The question the portfolio currently leaves unanswered is: does Bryan think about design at the systems and decisions level, or only at the execution level? Right now I can't tell, and I need to be able to tell before I make a call.

This report was generated using the Portfolio Review skill, created by Won J. You.